shareholders.'[11] Saklatvala also told Ratanji that Sir Sassoon had resigned from the TIB Board and was actively opposing the move to amalgamate with the Central Bank of India by encouraging P.D. Shamdasani, a troublesome shareholder, to gather proxies to defeat the amalgamation. He wrote: 'SJ in this matter has behaved so dishonestly, first because he hates Pochkhanawala and then because he does not wish to see his Bank suffer, through this amalgamation, that he has not for a minute considered Bank or Tata interests.'[12]

The Central Bank took over the TIB as a going concern from July 5, 1923. Two shares of the TIB, each of the nominal values of ₹75 and paid-up value of ₹22.8 were exchanged for one share of the Central Bank which had a nominal value of ₹50 and paid-up value of ₹25. The TIB shareholders lost by exchange only ₹5 since the Central Bank's shares were then being quoted at ₹40. They also gained insofar as the uncalled liability of ₹105 on two Tata shares was now converted into an uncalled liability of ₹25 only on one Central Bank share. The difference of ₹5 was taken as writing off the losses of TIB.[13]

The amalgamation with TIB had a dramatic effect on the balance sheet of the Central Bank. The capital and reserve liability which stood at ₹80 lakhs in December 1922 rose to ₹2.68 crores in December 1923. The deposits rose from ₹14 crores to ₹18 crores. The ratio of capital and reserve to deposits which had sunk to as low as 5–7 percent during the First World War and after, now improved to 17–18 percent.[14] The investments which had rarely been above 20 percent shot up to touch 53 percent in the next two years. As Muranjan observes, 'The balance sheet has never lost its mark of the great amalgamation.'[15]

Notwithstanding Sir Sassoon's intentions, as a result of the amalgamation, Stringfellow's 'huge joke' became the largest joint-stock bank in the country just twelve years after it was founded. Sorabji, who was not given to public self-congratulation, might just have had a chuckle or two in private at the memory.

Acknowledgement of Sorabji's achievement came from many sources. Nowroji Saklatvala and another Director, F.E. Dinshaw, in supporting the amalgamation observed: 'The scheme, if adopted, will result in the creation of a very powerful Indian banking institution under the able management of